

IDS11072
Australian Government Bureau of Meteorology
South Australia

Coastal Waters Forecast for South Australia

Issued at 3:40 am CST on Thursday 24 September 2026
for the period until midnight CST Saturday 26 September 2026.

Please be aware

Wind and wave forecasts are averages. Wind gusts can be 40 per cent stronger than the forecast, and stronger still in squalls and thunderstorms. Maximum waves can be twice the forecast height.

Warning Information

For latest warnings go to www.bom.gov.au, subscribe to RSS feeds, call 1300 659 210* or listen for warnings on relevant TV and radio broadcasts.

Weather Situation

A high pressure system centred over the Tasman Sea extends a ridge westwards over central and eastern SA and a low pressure trough extends from WA over western SA. This trough will be very slow-moving for the rest of the week and over the weekend and the ridge will move away to the east. A weakening cold front will slip across southern coasts late Thursday and early Friday.

Far West Coast: WA-SA Border to Fowlers Bay

Forecast for Thursday 24 September until midnight

Winds: Northwest to northeasterly 10 to 15 knots tending northwest to southwesterly in the early morning then tending southeast to southwesterly in the middle of the day. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 1.5 to 2 metres, decreasing to 1.5 metres during the afternoon. Weather: Cloudy. 60% chance of showers. The chance of a thunderstorm.

Forecast for Friday 25 September

Winds: Southeasterly 15 to 20 knots. Seas: Below 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 1.5 metres by early evening. Swell: Southwesterly 1.5 metres. Weather: Cloudy. 50% chance of showers. The chance of a thunderstorm in the evening.

Forecast for Saturday 26 September

Winds: Southeasterly 15 to 25 knots. Seas: 1.5 metres, increasing to 1.5 to 2 metres during the morning. 1st Swell: Southwesterly 1.5 metres, increasing to 1.5 to 2.5 metres during the morning. 2nd Swell: Below 0.5 metres, tending southeasterly 1 to 1.5 metres during the morning. Weather: Cloudy. 70% chance of showers.

Upper West Coast: Fowlers Bay to Elliston

Forecast for Thursday 24 September until midnight

Winds: North to northeasterly 10 to 15 knots shifting south to southwesterly in the late morning and early afternoon. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 1.5 to 2 metres, decreasing to 1.5 metres later in the evening. Weather: Cloudy.

Forecast for Friday 25 September

Winds: South to southeasterly about 10 knots increasing to 15 to 20 knots in the middle of the day. Seas: Below 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 1.5 metres by early evening. Swell: Southwesterly 1.5 metres. Weather: Partly cloudy. 50% chance of showers.

Forecast for Saturday 26 September

Winds: Southeasterly 15 to 25 knots. Seas: 1 to 1.5 metres, increasing to 1.5 to 2 metres during the afternoon or evening. 1st Swell: Southwesterly 1.5 metres, increasing to 1.5 to 2.5 metres during the morning. 2nd Swell: Southeast to southwesterly around 1 metre. Weather: Cloudy. 50% chance of showers.

Lower West Coast: Elliston to Cape Carnot

Forecast for Thursday 24 September until midnight

Winds: Northerly 10 to 15 knots shifting south to southwesterly below 10 knots in the late afternoon. Seas: Around 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 1.5 to 2 metres, decreasing to 1.5 metres later in the evening. Weather: Cloudy. 60% chance of showers.

Forecast for Friday 25 September

Winds: Southerly 10 to 15 knots tending southeasterly 15 to 20 knots in the early morning. Seas: Below 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 1.5 metres by early evening. Swell: Southwesterly 1.5 metres, increasing to 1.5 to 2 metres around midday. Weather: Cloudy. 60% chance of showers. The chance of a thunderstorm in the late morning.

Forecast for Saturday 26 September

Winds: Southeasterly 15 to 25 knots increasing to 20 to 30 knots during the evening. Seas: 1 to 1.5 metres, increasing to 1.5 to 2 metres during the afternoon. 1st Swell: Southwesterly 1.5 to 2 metres, increasing to 2 to 3 metres during the afternoon. 2nd Swell: Southeast to southwesterly around 1 metre. Weather: Cloudy. 80% chance of showers.

Central Coast

Forecast for Thursday 24 September until midnight

Winds: Northerly 10 to 15 knots, reaching up to 20 knots in the west in the late morning. Winds turning west to northwesterly below 10 knots in the late morning and early afternoon then becoming west to southwesterly in the evening. Seas: Around 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 2 metres, decreasing to 1.5 metres later in the evening. Weather: Cloudy. 80% chance of showers.

Forecast for Friday 25 September

Winds: South to southwesterly 10 to 15 knots becoming south to southeasterly about 10 knots before dawn then increasing to 10 to 15 knots in the morning. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 1.5 metres, increasing to 1.5 to 2 metres during the morning. Weather: Cloudy. 60% chance of showers. The chance of a thunderstorm in the morning and afternoon.

Forecast for Saturday 26 September

Winds: Southeasterly 15 to 20 knots increasing to 20 to 25 knots during the afternoon. Seas: 1 to 1.5 metres, increasing to 1 to 2 metres during the morning. 1st Swell: Southwesterly 2 metres, increasing to 2 to 3 metres during the morning. 2nd Swell: Below 0.5 metres, tending southerly 1 to 1.5 metres during the morning. Weather: Cloudy. 80% chance of showers.

South Central Coast

Forecast for Thursday 24 September until midnight

Winds: North to northeasterly 15 to 20 knots tending north to northwesterly in the early morning then becoming west to northwesterly about 10 knots in the evening. Seas: Around 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 1.5 to 2.5 metres. Weather: Cloudy. 80% chance of showers.

Forecast for Friday 25 September

Winds: South to southwesterly about 10 knots tending south to southeasterly 10 to 15 knots in the middle of the day. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 1.5 metres, increasing to 1.5 to 2 metres during the morning. Weather: Cloudy. 60% chance of showers. The chance of a thunderstorm in the afternoon.

Forecast for Saturday 26 September

Winds: Southeasterly 15 to 20 knots increasing to 20 to 25 knots during the afternoon. Seas: Around 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 2 metres during the morning. 1st Swell: Southwesterly 2 to 3 metres. 2nd Swell: Southeast to southwesterly below 1 metre, increasing to around 1 metre west of Kangaroo Island during the afternoon or evening. Weather: Cloudy. 80% chance of showers.

Upper South East Coast: Murray Mouth to Cape Jaffa

Forecast for Thursday 24 September until midnight

Winds: North to northeasterly 10 to 15 knots, reaching up to 20 knots offshore early in the morning. Winds turning west to northwesterly below 10 knots in the evening. Seas: Around 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 1.5 to 2.5 metres. Weather: Cloudy. 50% chance of showers.

Forecast for Friday 25 September

Winds: West to southwesterly about 10 knots tending south to southwesterly 10 to 15 knots in the morning then tending south to southeasterly in the late afternoon. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 1.5 metres, increasing to 1.5 to 2 metres south of Salt Creek. Weather: Cloudy. 70% chance of showers.

Forecast for Saturday 26 September

Winds: Southeasterly 15 to 20 knots increasing to 20 to 25 knots during the evening. Seas: Around 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 2 metres during the afternoon or evening. Swell: Southwesterly 2 metres, increasing to 2 to 3 metres during the afternoon. Weather: Cloudy. 90% chance of showers.

Lower South East Coast: Cape Jaffa to SA-VIC Border

Forecast for Thursday 24 September until midnight

Winds: Northerly 15 to 20 knots turning northwesterly 10 to 15 knots in the afternoon. Seas: Around 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 1.5 metres during the morning, then decreasing below 1 metre by early evening. Swell: Southwesterly 2 to 2.5 metres. Weather: Cloudy. 70% chance of showers.

Forecast for Friday 25 September

Winds: Westerly 10 to 15 knots becoming southwesterly about 10 knots in the early morning then tending southerly 10 to 15 knots in the morning. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 1.5 to 2 metres. Weather: Cloudy. 70% chance of showers.

Forecast for Saturday 26 September

Winds: Southerly 10 to 15 knots turning southeasterly 15 to 20 knots during the morning. Seas: Around 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 1.5 metres during the afternoon. Swell: Southwesterly 2 to 3 metres. Weather: Cloudy. 70% chance of showers.

Spencer Gulf

Forecast for Thursday 24 September until midnight

Winds: North to northeasterly 10 to 15 knots shifting south to southwesterly in the evening. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: South to southwesterly below 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 1.5 metres south of Cowell to Wallaroo. Weather: Partly cloudy. 50% chance of showers south of Port Neill to Port Victoria, near zero chance elsewhere.

Forecast for Friday 25 September

Winds: South to southwesterly 10 to 15 knots tending south to southeasterly during the day. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: South to southwesterly around 1 metre. Weather: Partly cloudy. 50% chance of showers south of Cowell to Wallaroo, near zero chance elsewhere. The chance of a thunderstorm south of Port Neill to Port Victoria in the morning and afternoon.

Forecast for Saturday 26 September

Winds: South to southeasterly 15 to 25 knots. Seas: 1 to 1.5 metres, increasing to 1.5 to 2 metres during the afternoon or evening. Swell: South to southwesterly below 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 1.5 metres south of Cowell to Wallaroo. Weather: Cloudy. 50% chance of showers.

Gulf St Vincent

Forecast for Thursday 24 September until midnight

Winds: North to northeasterly 10 to 15 knots decreasing to about 10 knots in the morning then becoming south to southwesterly in the evening. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: West to southwesterly below 0.5 metres. Weather: Partly cloudy.

Forecast for Friday 25 September

Winds: South to southwesterly 10 to 15 knots tending south to southeasterly in the evening. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: West to southwesterly below 0.5 metres. Weather: Partly cloudy.

Forecast for Saturday 26 September

Winds: Southerly 10 to 15 knots turning southeasterly 15 to 20 knots during the day. Seas: Around 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 1.5 metres during the afternoon or evening. Swell: West to southwesterly below 0.5 metres. Weather: Cloudy. 60% chance of showers.

Investigator Strait

Forecast for Thursday 24 September until midnight

Winds: North to northeasterly 10 to 15 knots, reaching up to 20 knots through the Backstairs Passage during the morning. Winds becoming variable below 10 knots in the late afternoon. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: West to southwesterly below 1 metre. Weather: Cloudy. 60% chance of showers.

Forecast for Friday 25 September

Winds: Variable about 10 knots becoming southeasterly 10 to 15 knots in the early afternoon. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: West to southwesterly below 1 metre. Weather: Partly cloudy. 70% chance of showers. The chance of a thunderstorm in the morning and afternoon.

Forecast for Saturday 26 September

Winds: Southeasterly 15 to 20 knots. Seas: Around 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 1.5 metres during the afternoon. Swell: West to southwesterly around 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 1.5 metres inshore during the afternoon or evening. Weather: Cloudy. 80% chance of showers.

The next routine forecast will be issued at 9:30 am CST Thursday.

* Calls to 1300 numbers cost around 27.5c incl. GST, higher from mobiles or public phones. Marine forecasts are also available on VHF and HF radio. View the radio schedule on www.bom.gov.au/marine

Check the latest Coastal Waters Forecasts for information on wind, wave and weather conditions for neighbouring coastal zones.